

Some highlights of this CAD/CAM software are:

New 3D-View feature. 3D-View feature of PCB Investigator contains functions for a realistic (3D) representation of PCB components, signals and drills as a network.

A fast, simple and detailed 3D representation of components allows a preview of the finished solution. The zoom option allows a close view to even the smallest part in 3D. Predefined views make it easy to use the 3D. The integrated rotation with arbitrarily selectable axis offers a view from every angle. Coil or ring networks can be identified in an amazingly short time. Up-to-date data is available at all the stations at the same time. Sources of errors and numbers of reoperations are minimised. Problems like faulty assemblies are identified and corrected easily. Higher punctuality of delivery to customers leads to time savings. Preparation costs too fall by saving precious time.

Viewing and editing PCB production data. You can check the intelligent output of the PCB design system before sending it to the manufacturer.

Complete electronic development at one place. ODB++ helps to combine PCBs to use different CAD programs such as Mentor Expedition and Zuken CR 5000, allowing complete electronic development at one place.

Support at every development and production stage. Every development and production stage can be completely observed without using any sheet of paper. The complete workflow of the development and production process—incoming orders, equipment, assembly, functional check, packaging and even delivery—becomes digital making the printing of endless documents unnecessary.

EDA multiboard panel builder. It is possible to combine different boards in one panel with the plug-in EDA panel builder available for PCB Investigator. The EDA multiboard panel builder enables combination of different PCBs to trace a net over the limit of a PCB. It also offers the opportunity to import a second PCB including net data, as well as free positioning on a panel. The modular development of electronic and mechatronic systems gets closer.

Paperless fabrication. PCB Investigator achieves the goal of paperless PCB fabrication. This helps eliminate unnecessary piles of paper while increasing the quality with zero-defect production and lowering the costs.

Applying PCB Investigator in every step of the manufacturing process allows you to finish projects faster without using a sheet of paper. At each work station, the latest version of project is available by using a central server in the 'paperless factory', so waiting for the new version

(improved sketches) finally comes to an end.

3D view with sketchup export. This feature lets you convert your design to 3D and combine it with other 3D parts. You can convert ODB++, IPC2581 and GenCad files to Google SketchUp 3D. Export feature writes the board and components of your design in Collada file format.

Edit component: The plug-in for electronic change proposals. With this plug-in you can select a component in the design to edit its properties. For example, you can add or change height, rotation, mirror and location of the selected component.

Component connections. The new plug-in component connections allow you to see the connections of a previously selected object of the board. The detailed view displays more information about the selected object—for example, the network, the distance or the total net length. It also helps to check whether each pin has a blocking capacitor.

EZ Schematics

EZ Schematics is an easy-to-use CAD program to draw and print electrical schematics and/or diagrams. Users can quickly and easily transform electrical relay logic concepts into digital documents (as line diagrams) that can be saved and printed with professional appearance.

EZ Schematics is a great CAD program for producing electrical schematics in the following ways:

1. It is easier to learn than many programs
2. Almost all the electrical symbols are created in 1.27cm-scale increments designed to align perfectly with the default snap (also set at 1.27 cm), thus making precise placement of symbols a breeze
3. NEMA is the default symbols library from which most US electrical schematics are developed. This eliminates any waste of time in choosing from a number of unnecessary options
4. Smart choice labelling is used to insert a symbol. For example, when

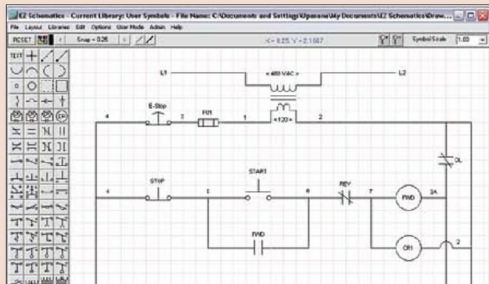


Fig. 2: EZ Schematics